

Psychological Harassment at Work

Recognize, document, protect yourself

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Recognize, document, protect yourself

Psychological harassment at work is repeated behavior that degrades your working conditions and your health: being sidelined, humiliated, overloaded or benched, endlessly criticized, set impossible targets. Over time, you doubt yourself and burn out. It's neither normal nor your fault.

This guide helps you recognize harassment, protect your self-esteem and health, and lean on the right channels — without carrying it alone.

Your intention

What, in your work situation, degrades or exhausts you: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Why you end up doubting yourself

From being criticized, sidelined, or disqualified, you internalize the message: 'I'm useless', 'I brought it on myself'. Harassment shifts onto the victim a responsibility that isn't theirs.

Understanding that shift restores your clarity: the degradation comes from the behavior, not from you.

Example

Sure he was 'the problem', Marc realized, laying out the facts, that the attacks were systematic and targeted.

What I internalized

Which messages about myself did I end up believing at work?

Facts, not verdict

List 3 precise facts (who, what, when) that degrade your conditions.

→ *The degradation comes from the behavior — not a flaw in me.*

The thoughts that trap you

'I have no right to complain', 'no one will believe me', 'I must hold on': these thoughts isolate you and delay your protection.

Testing them against the facts and your rights reopens options.

Example

Sure 'no one would believe her', Inès showed her dated emails to occupational health. She was heard.

Behavior journal

Note each fact: date · what happened · witnesses · impact on me.

Reframe

Turn 'no one will believe me' into 'I have dated facts and, sometimes, witnesses'.

→ *My dated facts are solid ground — I'm not powerless.*

Protecting your self-esteem & health

Your health comes before a job. Don't let harassment define your worth: you remain competent and worthy, regardless of what you're put through.

Taking care of yourself (rest, support, care) isn't a luxury: it's vital.

Example

Leaning on her past achievements and outside support, Léa held on long enough to protect herself.

My worth, beyond their gaze

Write 5 truths about your skills and qualities, independent of this situation.

Taking care of myself

What can I put in place for my health (doctor, rest, support)?

→ *My worth stays intact — and my health comes first.*

Leaning on the right channels

You don't have to face this alone. Channels exist: occupational health, staff representatives or a union, HR, a labor inspectorate, and victim-support services. Documenting and building support is protecting yourself.

Choosing your supports and your timing is part of the strategy.

Example

By contacting occupational health and a staff representative, Sofia set in motion a protection she thought out of reach.

My channels

Note: 1 internal channel (occupational health, reps, HR) · 1 external (inspectorate, victim support).

My next step

Which channel will I contact first, and when?

→ *Leaning on the right channels turns isolation into protection.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Harassment = repeated behavior that degrades your conditions and health.
- Document everything: dates, facts, emails, witnesses, impact — in a safe (non-work) place.
- Talk to occupational health: bound by confidentiality, they can act.
- Lean on staff representatives / union, and a labor inspectorate.
- Your health comes before a job — seek care if needed.
- A victim-support service can guide you. You're not alone.

To fill in

Behavior journal

Date	The fact	Witnesses	Impact on me

My channels

Channel (internal/external)	Next step

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Recognize and lay out the facts.

Week 2 — Test the isolating thoughts against facts.

Week 3 — Protect my self-esteem & health.

Week 4 — Lean on the right channels.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The fact I document first:
- The truth about my worth I hold onto:
- The channel I contact first:

TO CLOSE

Recognize, document, build support — it's not your fault, and you're not alone.

It's not your fault, and you're not alone.

This guide helps you recognize and name what you're living at work: it's a psychoeducation and coaching tool, not therapy or legal advice. For support, you can turn to occupational health, staff representatives, a labor inspectorate, or a victim-support service in your country. If you're going through a very hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.